

The 6:15

SUNDAY · SEPTEMBER 6, 2026

NO. 11

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (WEEKEND — CONDENSED)

This week Mon 9/7 Labor Day (markets closed); Tue 9/8 3-yr Treasury auction & NH Dem. Senate primary (Pappas–Manzur); Wed 9/9 10-yr reopening (settles 9/15) & RNC midterm convention opens, Dallas (Vance speaks); Thu 9/10 Oracle & Adobe report after close, RNC Day 2 (Trump keynotes), 30-yr reopening expected by pattern **[unconfirmed]**; Fri 9/11 Aug. CPI 8:30a BLS & Kroger reports; Tue–Wed 9/15–16 FOMC decision/SEP (2p/2:30p ET).

Ahead / other OPEC+ core-7 (JMMC) meets today to set Q4 quotas after completing its Sept. restoration hike — outcome not confirmed as of press time. **[NEW]** Crusoe raised \$3B+ Series F at a \$30B valuation (Sept. 3); G42 (Abu Dhabi) weighing majority U.S. ownership to lock in Nvidia chip access. No verified rocket launch fell in this run's window — Starship Flight 14's date is contested (NET 9/15, or slipping to 9/30).

Xi-Trump Washington summit (Sept. 24) falls outside the 10-day window; see Geopolitics.

METRICS · WEEKEND — AS OF FRI 9/4 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED

Oil / Rates / FX Brent ~\$96.28 (ICE, Fri settle; sources ranged \$95.63–97.36, **unconfirmed vs. exchange feed**); WTI ~\$91.0–91.5 (NYMEX, same flag); spread ~\$5. 10Y 4.78%, 2Y 4.37%, 30Y 5.24% (Treasury.gov par curve, 9/4). DXY 99.16–99.18 (9/4).

Equities / Vol / Commods S&P 7,718.60 (-0.38%), Dow 53,414.25 (-0.51%), Nasdaq 26,506.99 (-0.29%) — Fri close, reversing Thu's rally on the hot jobs print. VIX ~14.3–14.5. Gold ~\$4,400–4,420/oz **[unconfirmed vs. Kitco]**. Retail gas \$4.1473/gal (AAA, as of 9/6). Asia/Europe Fri closes **single-sourced, unverified**: Nikkei 65,020.94 (+1.26%), Hang Seng 25,213 (-0.4%), DAX 26,046.40, FTSE 10,831.09, CAC 8,278.77.

CME FedWatch's Sept.-hike probability: 65.9% (Wed) → ~coin flip (Thu, on Waller) → 60.4% (Fri close, on payrolls) — see Lead. A live pre-print pull returned conflicting 58–66% reads from other aggregators; treat 60.4% (tied explicitly to the jobs reaction) as best-supported.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 189 (straits.live, 6 Sep 10:17 UTC) / Day 190 (globalsecurity.org, 5 Sep) — counting-convention gap, same Feb. 28 anchor date.
Transits	Kpler: 6 vessels (Sept. 2) vs. its 10-day avg. of ~13/day. PortWatch: 6 transits, dated Aug. 30 (baseline cited as 74–85/day, sources disagree) — normal weekly-refresh lag, not a fresh Sept. 5–6 reading.
Dark tankers	No fresh reading; AXSMarine's 62% (data through Aug. 6) and Gulf News's ~80% (~mid/late Aug.) are both stale.
War-risk premia	~40x pre-crisis, ~\$10M per VLCC passage (straits.live, 6 Sep 10:17 UTC; directionally corroborated by trade paper Insurance Day) — no named underwriter.
Strikes, running total	No official U.S. or Iranian count exists. Unofficial trackers cite 115+ strikes (iranstrikemap.com) / 174 equipment losses (globalmilitary.net) — both single-sourced, non-government.

Methodology, unchanged: Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots, and trade-press war-risk estimates measure different things over different windows and are never netted or averaged against one another.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	L 3-2 Fri, W 5-1 Sat vs. San Diego; 80-61, 2nd AL East, top AL wild card.
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unresolved — reported ~3-yr/\$54-62M framework vs. his up-to-4-yr/\$132M max eligibility.
Northwestern	Opened 1-0, beat South Dakota State 34-18 Saturday.

LEAD

RATES · OIL · IRAN

A hot jobs print and a Hormuz missile exchange erase two weeks of dovish drift in 48 hours

Friday's August jobs report reversed Thursday's Fed-split rally almost exactly. Nonfarm payrolls rose 162,000 in August — roughly triple the Dow Jones consensus of about 53,000 — while June and July were revised up a combined 55,000 (July's shock -23,000 miss now reads +21,000). Unemployment held at 4.1%, average hourly earnings rose 0.3% to \$37.75, and labor-force participation ticked up to 61.6%. [NEW] [fact] Markets read it as good-news-is-bad-news for the Warsh–Waller split flagged in Thursday's issue: CME FedWatch's implied odds of a September hike jumped to 60.4% at Friday's close from roughly a coin flip Thursday, the ten-year yield resumed rising to 4.78%, the two-year touched its highest level since January 2025, and equities gave back Thursday's gains — the Dow fell 271.85 points (-0.51%) to 53,414.25, the S&P 500 dropped 0.38% to 7,718.60, the Nasdaq slipped 0.29% to 26,506.99. [fact] Fifth Third's Bill Adams put the read plainly: the print puts the Fed "squarely on controlling inflation when they meet next in September." [read] In three sessions, hike odds ran from 65.9% (Wed) to a coin flip (Thu, on Gov. Waller's dovish break) to 60.4% (Fri, on payrolls) — the committee split is still live, and Waller's own named tiebreaker, the Aug. CPI print due Sept. 11, now carries more weight than ever.

Then Saturday, the war caught up with the rhetoric. Iran fired multiple ballistic missiles at a U.S. Navy carrier and a guided-missile destroyer in the Gulf; CENTCOM says both ships evaded them with no American casualties. [NEW] [fact] Washington retaliated within hours, striking and disabling or destroying three more Iranian crude tankers — the Downy off Kharg Island, the Stark 1 near Jask, and the Kylo in the Gulf of Oman, whose crew was ordered to abandon ship. [fact] CENTCOM's Adm. Brad Cooper: "If

you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours." Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth vowed to keep sinking tankers "if Iran shoots at U.S. ships." [fact] Iran's Khatam al-Anbiya command threatened retaliation "more severe than before"; separately, the IRGC navy claimed it hit three more tankers and three U.S.-linked vessels overnight — unconfirmed by the U.S. as of this filing. [fact, flag: Iranian claim, not independently confirmed]

The timing matters. Less than 24 hours before Saturday's missile exchange, Trump had called the six-week-old conflict "small potatoes" and Vance said he "wouldn't call it a war" — a framing the administration has not publicly reconciled with a carrier group now dodging live ballistic missiles. [read] Brent was already up roughly 9% for the week into Friday's settle, its best week since mid-July, on the earlier round of strikes alone; Saturday's escalation postdates that settle entirely, so none of it is in a confirmed price yet. [fact/read] With OPEC+'s core group meeting today to set Q4 quotas (outcome not yet confirmed as of this filing) and the Aug. CPI print — the data point Waller named as decisive for his vote — due Thursday, a Monday oil gap-up would land at nearly the worst possible moment for the Fed's inflation math, just as the committee is genuinely split for the first time this cycle. [read] That is the setup this issue's reader carries into Monday: a jobs print that just re-hawked the curve, a war the administration calls over that the Pentagon is actively fighting, and a CPI print eight days out that both sides of the Fed have now flagged as the thing that decides September.

POLITICS

A federal judge in Boston, Indira Talwani, ruled Friday that a new USPS rule requiring election officials to obtain advance postal approval — through an online portal that doesn't yet exist — before mailing ballots is likely unlawful, calling compliance "implausible" given ballots are already going out in some states; the administration is separately appealing a related mail-voting order to the Supreme Court. [NEW] [fact] Melania Trump and more than 45 Republican lawmakers and candidates are skipping the RNC's midterm convention in Dallas (Sept. 9-10; Vance speaks the 9th, Trump keynotes the 10th), citing prior obligations, days after a Reuters/Ipsos poll put Trump's approval at 33%, a term low. [NEW] [fact] New Hampshire's Democratic Senate primary (Pappas vs. Manzur, Sept. 8) is reported tightening in its final days. [fact] The single-sourced claim that Trump told House Republicans a midterm loss risks impeachment proceedings remains uncorroborated by any second source. [continuity, flag: single-sourced]

ECONOMICS

Beyond Friday's jobs print (see Lead), the week ahead runs straight into the Aug. CPI report, due Thursday at 8:30a ET (BLS) — consensus, per a single FactSet-attributed aggregator not independently cross-checked, calls for headline +0.3% m/m/+2.9% y/y and core +0.3%/+3.1% y/y; Ameriprise's Russell Price is on record expecting a hotter 0.4% m/m. [flag: single-sourced consensus] Treasury auctions a 3-year note Tuesday and reopens the 10-year Wednesday (settling Sept. 15); a 30-year reopening would fall Thursday by the standard monthly pattern, but no announcement confirming date or size was located this run. [flag: inferred, not confirmed] Fed funds remain targeted at 3.50%-3.75%. [continuity]

BUSINESS

Tesla's invite-only Cybercab relaunch Thursday evening in Austin — Musk did not appear — left pricing, production and regulatory questions unanswered; shares fell 5.9% Friday to \$354.08, and NHTSA opened a safety/certification probe the same day commercial deployment began, citing wrong-route and skipped-destination complaints. [NEW] [fact] Blue Owl Capital is planning to seed and take public a data-center REIT with roughly \$6.5B of its own assets to fund further buildouts. [NEW] [fact] Nigeria's SEC cleared the Dangote Refinery's roughly \$1.6B IPO — the country's largest ever — opening Sept. 14 to fund expanding Lagos refining capacity from 700,000 to 1.4M bpd. [NEW] [fact] Nvidia's \$12.9B Hugging Face deal and Amazon's FTC ad-pricing suit carry over with no new developments this weekend. [continuity]

TECHNOLOGY

OpenAI says it completed a staggered rollout of GPT-6 Astra to all ChatGPT Plus, Pro, Business and Enterprise tiers by Sept. 5, apologized for a "messy rollout," and is banking subscribers a usage reset for every day they lacked access; API/developer availability is still described as "coming days," not yet confirmed generally available. [NEW] [fact, flag: moderately sourced, not an OpenAI primary statement independently verified] Microsoft AI released MAI-Transcribe-2, claiming the top FLEURS benchmark score across 60 languages at roughly 72% lower cost than its predecessor. [NEW] [fact] Crusoe, the AI-cloud and data-center provider, raised over \$3B in a Series F at a \$30B valuation — nearly triple its October figure — led by Atreides Management and Valor Equity Partners, with Mubadala Capital participating. [NEW] [fact] Abu

Dhabi's G42 is weighing majority U.S. ownership to lock in Nvidia chip access beyond its current license, good through roughly April 2027. [NEW] [fact] Anthropic's IPO timeline is unchanged. [continuity]

GEOPOLITICS

Trump envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner met Putin in Moscow for roughly three hours plus dinner Saturday — the first Moscow visit of this diplomatic push — after which Russia and Ukraine agreed to a mutual pause on capital-city strikes; the envoys arrived in Kyiv Sunday with what the White House calls a "concrete proposal," details promised in coming weeks, while Zelensky reiterated Ukraine's red lines on territory and NATO aspirations. [NEW] [fact] The truce didn't hold nationwide: a Russian missile strike killed five in Kamianske, Dnipropetrovsk Oblast, Saturday, and Ukrainian officials reported roughly 886 strikes on 54 Zaporizhzhia-region settlements in 24 hours, with 245 front-line combat engagements Sept. 5, concentrated at Pokrovsk. [fact] An IAEA-brokered local ceasefire let Ukrainian technicians repair power-line damage at the Zaporizhzhia nuclear plant Sept. 5. [fact] Israel struck Hezbollah targets in southern Lebanon Sept. 5-6 after alleging drone launches at a security-zone position, killing at least four near Arab Salim — a discrete new flare-up, separate from Gaza and Iran. [NEW] [fact]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Saturday's carrier-group missile exchange and the retaliatory tanker strikes (see Lead), the granular counters: closure trackers put the Strait at Day 189 (straits.live) or Day 190 (globalsecurity.org) since the Feb. 28 declaration — a counting-convention gap, not a factual one, both anchored to the same date. [flag: tracker methodology] Kpler's cleanest recent transit read is 6 vessels on Sept. 2 against its own 10-day average of ~13/day; PortWatch's last

confirmed snapshot, also 6 transits, is dated Aug. 30 against a baseline sources give as either 74 or 85/day — consistent with PortWatch's normal weekly lag, not a fresh weekend reading. [flag: stale] Per standing policy these are never averaged: Kpler/PortWatch count AIS pings on different windows, while U.S. officials (Trump has cited ~30 ships/day, Treasury Secretary Bessent 10-17M bbl/day) count a broader vessel universe via classified sensors — a gap Al Jazeera reports as unresolved between the two camps. [fact]

Dark-AIS share has no reading dated to this weekend; the most recent hard figures are AXSMarine's 62% (data through Aug. 6) and a Gulf News estimate near 80% (roughly mid-to-late August) — both stale, cited only for range. [flag: stale] War-risk premia are quoted by straits.live at roughly 40x pre-crisis rates and ~\$10M per VLCC passage; trade paper Insurance Day corroborates the ballpark ("tops \$10 million for a single VLCC trip") without a precise date, but neither source names an underwriter, so treat the multiple as directional. [flag: single-sourced aggregator] No outlet publishes an official cumulative strike count; unofficial trackers cite 115+ strikes since Feb. 28 (iranstrikemap.com) and 174 documented equipment losses (globalmilitary.net) — both single-sourced, non-government. [flag] Casualty figures are more consistently corroborated: Iran's health ministry reports 3,468+ killed domestically; the U.S. reports 18 service members killed and 790+ wounded since the war began. [fact] No ceasefire talks or new mediation were reported this weekend; the IMO's most recent statement — citing roughly 400 ships and 6,000 seafarers stranded in the Gulf, at least 70 verified attacks on shipping, and 19 seafarers killed — is dated Aug. 28 and has not been updated. [flag: stale, no update since]

Yankees	Lost 3-2 Fri, won 5-1 Sat vs. San Diego; 80-61, 2nd AL East (Tampa Bay +4.5), top AL wild card; Sun. finale 4:10p ET not yet played.
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unresolved — reported ~3-yr/\$54-62M framework vs. up-to-4-yr/\$132M max eligibility; no deal signed.
Northwestern	Opened 1-0, beat South Dakota State 34-18 Saturday — Aidan Chiles' Northwestern debut (273 pass yds, 2 TDs), Joseph Himon II's 80-yard TD run sealed it.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 9/4: Apple's CEO transition, the funding bill, the Markey-Moulton primary. Broadcom's post-earnings reaction and Amazon's FTC suit carry over with no update. For next issue: watch Monday's open for a Hormuz-driven oil gap-up; watch whether the administration reconciles "small potatoes"/"not a war" with Saturday's carrier-group missile exchange; watch OPEC+'s Q4 quota decision (outcome pending at press time); watch the Aug. CPI print (Sept. 11) both Fed camps have flagged as decisive; watch the Witkoff-Kushner proposal's details, promised "in coming weeks"; watch GPT-6 Astra's API/developer rollout and the Josh Hart extension.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.